Worksheet for Nimi Afolabi's
"Civilized vs Uncivilized"
by Fareen Momen
(to be used with video linked here)

Key Takeaways:

1. In this two-page spread from *Muhammad Speaks*, how does Majied visually distinguish between "Civilized" and "Uncivilized" groups of people, and what message does this contrast communicate about proper Muslim appearance?

2. How does the depiction of afros, patterned clothing, and Soul Style in the "Uncivilized" panel reflect tensions between the Nation of Islam's dress codes and broader Black cultural movements of the 1970s?

3. In the final box, Black figures are shown following a "white savage" downward into darkness. What symbolic message does this convey about Elijah Muhammad's beliefs regarding white influence and cultural decline?

4. How does this graphic function as an argument about identity, culture, and belonging? In what ways does Majied use clothing and physical appearance as markers of moral or civilizational status?

Contextualizing the Work

What is another moment in American or global history during which clothing or hairstyle became a powerful symbol of identity, resistance, or moral judgment? How does that example help you understand the message in this NOI image?